Soft Transferable Skills vs Hard Professional Skills

Warm-Up

What is your strongest skill at work?

List as many soft skills as you can. Now list hard, job-specific skills.

Where do you draw the line between the two?

Common Soft Skills

Communication · teamwork · problem-solving · time management

Adaptability · leadership · critical thinking · interpersonal skills

Organization · emotional intelligence · creativity · negotiation

Common Hard Skills

Excel and data analysis · coding · a second language

Accounting · design software · operating machinery

Copywriting · project management tools · a driving licence

Discussion

For each skill above: what does it mean, and how does it shape your day?

Which transferable skills should every professional have?

Which type matters more in general? And in your own industry?

Can a hard skill be learned faster than a soft skill? Give an example.

How much time do you spend improving your soft and hard skills?

How could your leader or team help you build these skills?

How do you improve these skills on your own, after work?

What tools or apps do you use to practise them?

Which soft skill is hardest to fake in an interview, and why?

If you had to hire for one and train the other, which would you pick?